

Kent Chemical Laboratory D18



[If you have comments, send additional information](#)

Address: 1020-24 East 58th Street

Year Construction: 1894

Year Acquired: 1894

Architect: Henry Ives Cobb

Gross Square Feet: 69,912

Primary Use: Teaching

Design Zone: Main Quadrangle

Last Major Renovation:

1983

Comments:

Original chemistry building. Converted from chemistry research laboratory to instructional use in the 1960's.

REGULATORY STATUS

National Register: Not individually listed

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

Chicago HRS Color Code: Orange

1 - Site

Land Ownership Status: Owned

Location - Physical:

No comment

Location - Program Adjacency:

Connected to Jones Laboratory by basement corridor and via first floor connected walkway.

Location Comment:

One of original main quad buildings.

2 - Adaptability

Construction Type:

Load-bearing masonry walls and wood construction

Accessibility:

Entrance - Y; Bathrooms - P

Floor-to-Floor Height:

1st, 2nd: 15'-3", 3rd: 8'-0"

Structural Capability:

Adaptable subject to structural analysis.

Adaptability Exterior:

Exterior adaptation or addition would require sensitivity to integrity of existing facades.

Adaptability Interior:

Laboratory, office and classroom spaces - adaptable within construction type constraints.

Adaptability Physical Features:

Building massing resembles Ryerson Laboratory to the east but differs significantly in detail and placement of stair volumes.

Adaptability Structure:

Adaptable within construction type constraints.

Annex is distinctive auditorium within exposed construction.

3 - Building Envelope

Roof Type: Clay Tile (2003)

Exterior Facade:

Limestone

Exterior Base: Limestone

Exterior Trim: Limestone

4 - Heritage and Historic

Landmark Status:

no

National Register: Not individually listed

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

NR Comments:

Architectural significance, item #109 on district nomination form.

CHRS Comments:

Possesses potentially significant architectural or historical features

Heritage - Exterior:

Distinctive masonry facade facing main quad with significant entry doors.

Heritage - Interior:

Building was entirely renovated and abated in 1983 with original material removed. Interior circulation spaces and main staircase contain original

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architectural elements reinstalled after renovation. Classrooms and offices have received renovation work. Original bronze plaque of donor Sidney A. Kent by artist Lorado Taft is in the main lobby.

Significant Spaces Identified:

No Comment

Heritage Culture Elements:

Kent Lecture Hall was largest university auditorium prior to construction of Mandel Hall and was used for convocations and campus-wide activities.

Architectural Awards Certification:

None identified

Heritage and History - General Comments:

President Theodore Roosevelt was present at convocation in lecture hall in 1903. President McKinley given honorary degree at convocation in lecture hall. Presence of building (and Ryerson Laboratory adjacent and built at same time) is evidence of university's original commitment to integration of the sciences on the main quad.

5 - Sustainability

Certifications:

none identified

Window Last Replacement:

1988

Weather Stripping:

not identified

R Value Roof/Wall:

not identified

Systems:**Deficiencies:**